How Do You Make Money on TikTok? 10 Ways TikTok Creators Earn Money

10 Ways · Creators Earn Money · 2026 | Updated October 28, 2026

Short Answer: TikTok can become an income source through creator monetization programs, paid collaborations, affiliate promotions, and selling products or services.

If you've ever wondered **how do you make money on TikTok**, the answer is that creators can earn in several different ways. TikTok itself offers monetization features in eligible markets, but creators can also make money through sponsorships, affiliate marketing, products, services, LIVE content, and other business opportunities.

The important thing to understand is that TikTok income doesn't come from one single source. Some creators earn from their videos directly, while others use TikTok to build an audience and turn that audience into customers, clients, or buyers.

So, **can you make money on TikTok?** Yes, but the amount and available methods depend on your audience, location, content, eligibility, and monetization strategy.

In this guide, we'll look at 10 practical ways creators can make money on TikTok and how you can start building your own strategy.

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1. Join the TikTok Creator Rewards Program

One of the most direct ways to explore TikTok monetization is through the **Creator Rewards Program**.

The program is designed for eligible creators and rewards qualifying original content according to TikTok's current rules.

Availability and eligibility can vary by country, so creators should check TikTok Studio or the relevant monetization section of their account.

If the program is available to you, the general process is:

1. Build your TikTok account.
2. Create original content consistently.
3. Follow TikTok's Community Guidelines.
4. Check the current eligibility requirements.
5. Apply through TikTok when eligible.
6. Monitor your qualified views and rewards.

The Creator Rewards Program shouldn't be confused with the older **TikTok Creator Fund**, which is still a common search term even though TikTok has moved toward newer monetization programs in eligible markets.

2. Work With Brands

Brand partnerships are another major answer to **how to make money from TikTok**.

Companies can pay creators to feature their products or services in videos.

You don't necessarily need millions of followers.

A smaller creator with a specific audience can sometimes be attractive to a company because the audience is closely connected to the brand's target market.

For example:

* A gaming creator can work with gaming companies.
* A beauty creator can work with skincare brands.
* A technology creator can feature apps or accessories.
* A fitness creator can promote relevant equipment.
* A food creator can work with restaurants or food brands.

What brands may consider

Companies can look at:

* Average video views
* Engagement
* Audience demographics
* Content quality
* Niche
* Follower count
* Previous campaigns
* Location

Build your profile around a clear topic and create content that demonstrates what you can offer to potential partners.

3. Use Affiliate Marketing

Affiliate marketing allows creators to earn commissions when viewers purchase qualifying products through their promotional links or eligible TikTok shopping features.

This can work particularly well for product-focused content.

For example, a technology creator could make a video about:

"5 useful accessories for your home office."

Instead of simply listing the products, the creator can demonstrate how each one works and explain who might benefit from it.

Other affiliate-friendly niches include:

* Beauty
* Fashion
* Gaming
* Fitness
* Home improvement
* Travel
* Cooking
* Personal technology
* Education

The goal should be to recommend products that genuinely fit your content.

4. Sell Your Own Products

If you already have a product business, TikTok can become a powerful discovery

channel.

You could promote:

* Clothing
* Accessories
* Handmade products
* Artwork
* Beauty products
* Digital products
* Educational materials
* Customized products

The key is to create videos that show the product naturally.

Instead of making every video a direct advertisement, demonstrate how the product solves a problem or fits into everyday life.

For example, a stationery creator could show how they organize their desk using their own products.

That type of content can feel much more natural than repeatedly saying, "Buy my product."

5. Sell Digital Products

You don't need to manufacture physical products to make money with TikTok.

Digital products can be another option.

Examples include:

* Ebooks
* Templates
* Printable planners
* Study resources
* Design templates
* Presets
* Checklists
* Educational guides
* Online courses

Suppose your TikTok account focuses on productivity.

You could create short videos about time management and organization and offer a downloadable productivity planner for people who want a more complete system.

This gives your audience something useful while creating another potential source of income.

6. Offer Freelance Services

One of the easiest ways to understand **how to make money with TikTok** is to use TikTok as a portfolio.

If you have a skill, create videos that demonstrate it.

You could offer:

* Graphic design

* Video editing
* SEO
* Website development
* Writing
* Photography
* Social media management
* Tutoring
* Consulting
* Voice-over services

For example, a video editor can post:

Before → Editing Process → Final Video

A potential client can immediately see the creator's ability instead of simply reading a list of services.

TikTok can therefore generate leads even when TikTok itself isn't directly paying you.

7. Make Money Through TikTok LIVE

LIVE content gives creators another way to interact with their audience.

Eligible creators may have access to features that allow viewers to support them through virtual gifts and other available LIVE monetization options.

Creators use LIVE sessions for many different purposes:

* Gaming
* Q&A sessions

* Tutorials
* Music
* Interviews
* Product demonstrations
* Educational discussions
* Entertainment

A successful LIVE session usually gives viewers a reason to participate rather than simply watching a creator sit in front of a camera.

Prepare a topic, encourage questions, and keep the conversation moving.

8. Create UGC Content for Companies

User-generated content, commonly called UGC, is another potential way to earn from TikTok-style videos.

The interesting part is that you may not need a huge following.

A company may hire you because you can create natural-looking videos that demonstrate its product.

Examples include:

* Unboxing videos
* Product demonstrations
* Tutorials
* Testimonials
* Lifestyle videos
* Product comparisons

* Short advertisements

For someone who enjoys recording and editing videos, UGC can be an alternative to traditional influencer sponsorships.

You can create a small portfolio of sample videos and use it to approach businesses or find UGC opportunities.

9. Use TikTok to Promote a Business

TikTok can also help businesses generate customers.

You might own:

* A local business
* An online store
* A service company
* A consulting business
* A website
* A blog
* A digital product business

Your TikTok videos can introduce potential customers to the business.

For example, a local restaurant can post cooking videos, behind-the-scenes clips, customer favorites, and new menu items.

A digital marketing agency can publish short SEO tips.

A clothing business can show styling ideas.

The objective is to turn attention into a business relationship.

10. Build a Personal Brand

A personal brand can create several income opportunities over time.

Instead of focusing only on individual viral videos, build recognition around a specific subject.

For example:

Fitness creator → fitness content → coaching

Technology creator → technology content → affiliate products + sponsorships

Education creator → educational videos → courses + tutoring

Business creator → business content → consulting + digital products

This approach can make your TikTok account more valuable because your audience knows exactly what type of information or entertainment to expect.

How to Make Money on TikTok Without Millions of Followers

A common misconception is that you need millions of followers before you can start earning.

That's not necessarily true.

Different monetization methods require different types of audiences.

For example, imagine a TikTok account with 8,000 followers focused entirely on photography.

The creator could potentially earn through:

* Photography services
* Affiliate recommendations
* Brand partnerships
* Presets
* Digital guides
* UGC

The audience may be small compared with a major entertainment account, but it can be highly relevant.

This is why audience quality and niche can matter as much as raw follower count.

How to Get Monetized on TikTok

If your goal is direct TikTok monetization, start by checking the monetization options available in your TikTok account.

Requirements can vary depending on the program and country.

A good general approach is:

Step 1: Choose a niche

Pick a subject you can consistently create content about.

Step 2: Publish original videos

Avoid building your account entirely around copied or reused content.

Step 3: Build engagement

Encourage genuine interaction through useful, entertaining, or informative content.

Step 4: Follow TikTok's rules

Violations can affect eligibility for monetization features.

Step 5: Check TikTok Studio

Look at the monetization features available to your account.

Step 6: Apply when eligible

If a program is available and your account meets its current requirements, follow TikTok's application process.

How Do You Make Money on TikTok Videos?

There are several answers to this question.

You can potentially make money from videos through:

* Creator monetization programs
* Brand sponsorships

* Affiliate marketing
* Product promotion
* UGC
* Lead generation
* Services
* Business promotion

The best approach depends on what your videos are about.

A gaming creator and a freelance designer may use completely different monetization strategies.

How Much Money Can You Make on TikTok?

There isn't one fixed TikTok income rate that applies to everyone.

Earnings can depend on:

* Video performance
* Qualified views
* Audience location
* Niche
* Engagement
* Sponsorship agreements
* Affiliate conversions
* Product sales
* Service pricing
* Monetization features available to the account

For example, one creator may make most of their income from sponsorships while

another earns primarily from selling products.

Therefore, don't judge your potential earnings only by follower count.

TikTok Creator Fund vs Creator Rewards Program

The phrase **TikTok Creator Fund** remains popular in searches because it was an earlier monetization program.

TikTok has introduced the Creator Rewards Program in eligible markets as part of its newer creator monetization approach.

If you're researching either program, check the current information available inside your TikTok account because program names, requirements, and availability can change.

Don't rely on an old article that lists eligibility requirements without checking whether those requirements are still current.

Can You Make Money on TikTok From Views?

Potentially, but views alone don't guarantee income.

If you're participating in an eligible creator monetization program, TikTok determines qualifying views and rewards according to that program's rules.

Outside those programs, views can still be valuable because they can bring:

* New followers
* Potential customers
* Affiliate clicks
* Sponsorship opportunities

* Website visitors
* Product buyers

Think of views as attention.

The way you turn that attention into income depends on your monetization strategy.

How to Make Money Off TikTok as a Beginner

If you're starting from zero, don't try to implement every monetization method immediately.

Instead, follow a simple process.

Pick one topic

Choose something you understand and can discuss regularly.

Create useful videos

Answer questions, solve problems, demonstrate things, or entertain your audience.

Study your best-performing content

Look for patterns in:

* Topics
* Hooks
* Video length
* Comments

* Shares
* Watch time

Build trust

Don't promote random products simply because someone offers you money.

Introduce one monetization method

Once you have an audience, start with something that naturally fits your content.

For example:

Tech account → affiliate products

Education account → tutoring

Fitness account → coaching

Art account → digital products

Business account → consulting

5 Tips for Making Money on TikTok

1. Don't chase every trend

Trends can provide reach, but your content should still fit your niche.

2. Make the first few seconds useful

Give viewers a reason to continue watching.

3. Create content around questions

Search-based and question-based videos can attract people who are actively looking for information.

4. Build an audience you understand

Know what your viewers like, what problems they have, and what type of content they respond to.

5. Diversify your income

Don't depend entirely on one monetization feature.

A creator may combine affiliate income, sponsorships, digital products, and services rather than relying on one source.

Common Mistakes TikTok Creators Make

Trying to monetize too aggressively can hurt audience trust.

Avoid:

* Buying fake followers
* Buying artificial engagement
* Copying other creators
* Posting copyrighted material without permission

* Making unrealistic income claims
* Promoting irrelevant products
* Ignoring TikTok's policies
* Spamming promotional content
* Expecting every viral video to generate money

A large number of views is useful, but sustainable income usually comes from having a clear reason for those viewers to stay connected with you.

Frequently Asked Questions

How do you make money on TikTok?
Creators can potentially earn through TikTok's eligible monetization programs, brand sponsorships, affiliate marketing, LIVE features, products, services, UGC, and business promotion.

Can you make money on TikTok without followers?
You can begin building income opportunities before having a large following. Services, UGC, affiliate marketing, and products can potentially work with smaller audiences when the audience is relevant.

How do you make money from TikTok videos?
You can monetize videos directly through eligible TikTok programs or indirectly by using videos to generate sponsorships, affiliate sales, customers, product sales, or service leads.

How do I get monetized on TikTok?
Check TikTok Studio for monetization features available to your account and review the current eligibility requirements for your country and program.

Does TikTok pay creators for every view?

No. Not every view automatically generates money. Eligible monetization programs have their own rules regarding qualified views and rewards.

What is the TikTok Creator Fund?

The Creator Fund was an earlier TikTok creator monetization program. TikTok has since introduced newer programs such as the Creator Rewards Program in eligible markets.

Can you make money on TikTok with 1,000 followers?

Follower count alone doesn't determine your income. Depending on your niche and available features, you may be able to earn through services, affiliate marketing, products, UGC, sponsorships, or other methods.

Final Thoughts

So, **how do you make money on TikTok?** There isn't just one answer.

Creators can explore the Creator Rewards Program, sponsorships, affiliate marketing, products, services, LIVE features, UGC, and business opportunities. Some methods depend on TikTok's eligibility requirements, while others simply require an audience that trusts your recommendations.

If you're starting out, focus first on creating useful and consistent content. Once you understand your audience, choose monetization methods that naturally match your niche instead of trying to sell something in every video.

That approach gives you more ways to turn TikTok attention into a sustainable online income stream.

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